

Present Continuous

CEFR A1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

The present continuous (am/is/are + verb-ing) is for actions happening around now. Use it for:

- 1 Actions happening right now — She's reading a book.
- 2 Temporary situations — I'm staying with friends this week.
- 3 Future arrangements — We're meeting tomorrow at six.

For habits and permanent facts, use the present simple instead (She reads every night). Some verbs (know, like, want) are not normally used in the continuous.

At a glance

Form	Structure	Example
Affirmative	subject + am/is/are + verb- ing	She is working .
Negative	subject + am/is/are + not + verb-ing	They aren't listening .
Question	Am/Is/Are + subject + verb-ing?	Are you coming?

Learning objectives

- Can form affirmative, negative and interrogative present continuous sentences with am/is/are + -ing (CEFR A1).
- Can spell -ing forms correctly (drop final -e, double the consonant).
- Can choose the present continuous over the present simple for actions now, temporary situations and arrangements, and avoid it with stative verbs.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Present Continuous · CEFR A1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. Be quiet! The baby ____.

- A. sleeps
- B. is sleeping
- C. sleep
- D. sleeping

2. They ____ TV at the moment.

- A. are watching
- B. watch
- C. watches
- D. watching

3. I ____ this song. Turn it up!

- A. am liking
- B. like
- C. likes
- D. am like

4. She ____ to me!

- A. isn't listening
- B. doesn't listening
- C. not listening
- D. isn't listen

5. I ____ tennis every Sunday.

- A. 'm playing
- B. play
- C. playing
- D. am play

6. ____ it ____? Take an umbrella.

- A. Is / raining
- B. Does / raining
- C. Is / rain
- D. Are / raining

7. The -ing form of 'run' is ____.

- A. runing
- B. running
- C. runningg
- D. runs

8. We ____ Sara tomorrow evening.

- A. 're meeting
- B. meet
- C. meets
- D. met

9. Rewrite with the same meaning: 'I'm staying at a hotel until my flat is ready.'

- A. I always stay at a hotel.
- B. I'm temporarily staying at a hotel.
- C. I stayed at a hotel.
- D. I've never stayed at a hotel.

10. Look — he ____ the door for us.

- A. is opening
- B. opens
- C. open
- D. opened

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. is sleeping** — An action happening right now takes the present continuous: 'is sleeping'.
2. **A. are watching** — 'At the moment' signals now, so use are + verb-ing: 'are watching'.
3. **B. like** — 'Like' describes a feeling, not an action, so it stays in the present simple: 'I like'.
4. **A. isn't listening** — Present continuous negative = isn't + verb-ing: 'isn't listening'.
5. **B. play** — A regular habit ('every Sunday') takes the present simple: 'play'.
6. **A. Is / raining** — Present continuous question = Is + subject + verb-ing: 'Is it raining?'.
7. **B. running** — 'Run' doubles the final consonant before -ing: running.
8. **A. 're meeting** — For a fixed future arrangement, English uses the present continuous: 'We're meeting Sara tomorrow.'
9. **B. I'm temporarily staying at a hotel.** — The present continuous here shows a temporary situation, so 'temporarily staying' keeps the meaning.
10. **A. is opening** — 'Look —' points to an action in progress right now: 'is opening'.